

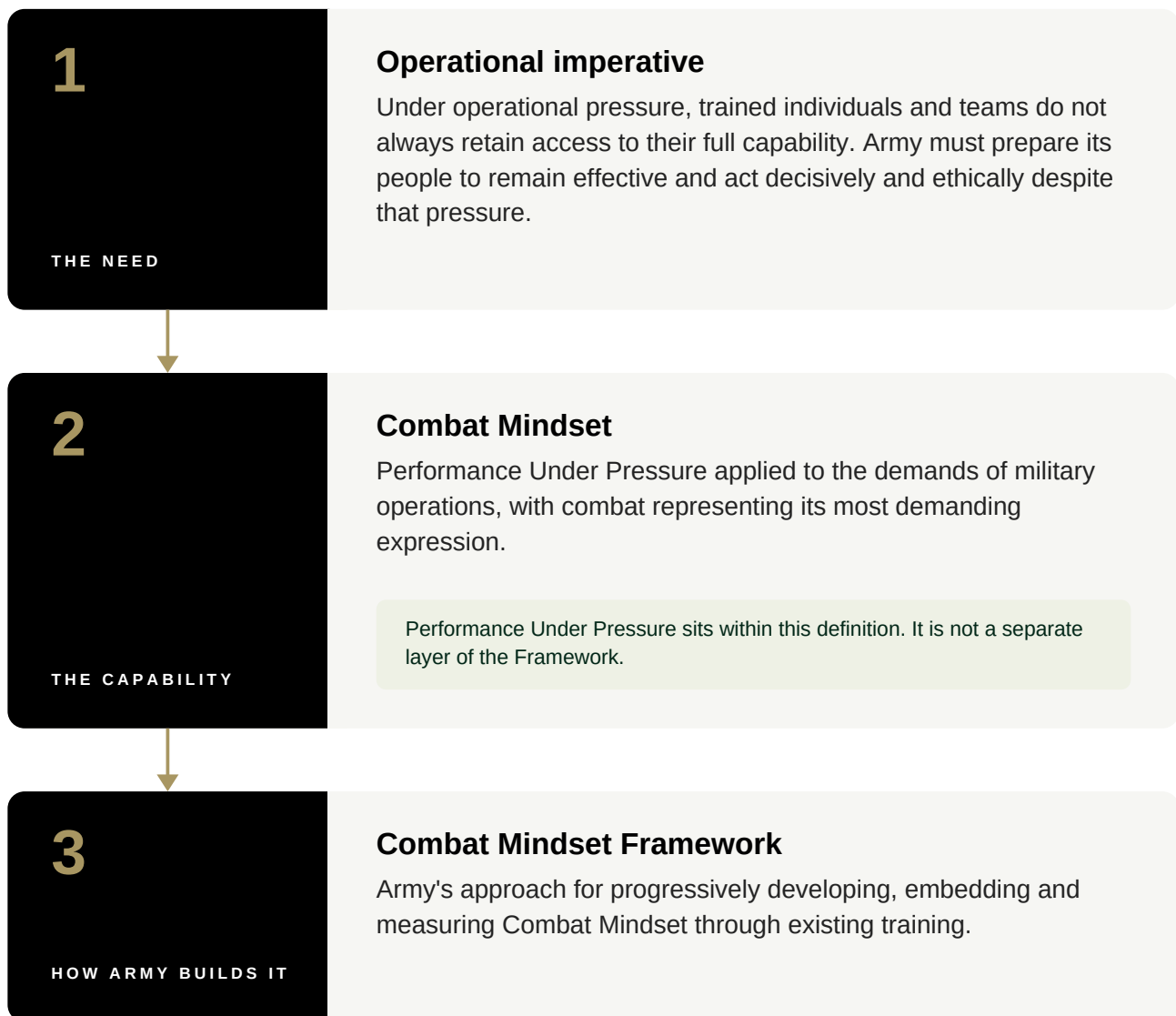
COMBAT MINDSET FRAMEWORK

Conceptual Baseline

New Zealand Army Leadership Centre | Army Command School

Reference: Working baseline for the Framework · **Date:** September 2026

The Framework rests on three statements. Each answers one question, and each depends on the one before it. Everything else in the Framework is tested against them.



THE NEED → THE CAPABILITY → HOW ARMY BUILDS IT

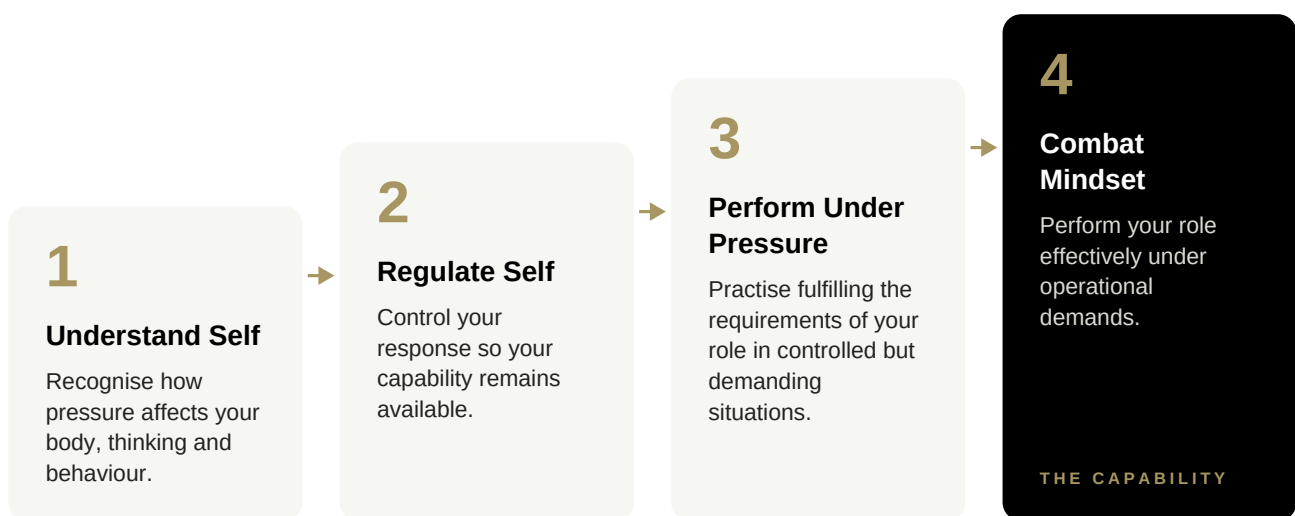
Working baseline. Any element of the Framework that does not serve the need, define the capability, or describe how Army builds it is simplified or removed.

How Combat Mindset Develops

New Zealand Army Leadership Centre | Army Command School

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Combat Mindset is a role-performance capability, not a leadership capability. The role changes by rank, appointment and function. The requirement does not: perform your role effectively under operational demands.



Understand yourself → regulate yourself → perform under pressure → perform your role under operational demands

What effective performance looks like depends on role and responsibility. It may involve leading others, but leadership is not a requirement for Combat Mindset.

For some people the role includes leading and influencing others. For others it means applying technical or tactical skills, following direction, communicating clearly and contributing to team performance.

THE SAME PATHWAY, WHATEVER THE ROLE

Private soldier

Section 2IC

Platoon commander

Specialist

Brigade commander

The final step is Combat Mindset. The pathway is the same for a private soldier, a section 2IC, a platoon commander, a specialist or a brigade commander. Leadership is not the organising feature of the capability.